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Part 1

The two most significant points in Jensen's article is the need for understanding: the political economy of digitization and the technical infrastructure of the archives.

Jensen argues that understanding the political economy of digitization is important.

Understanding how the popularity of a sub-field of study can influence what material could possibly be available in digital archives and more importantly why some material may not be.¹ Something as simple as the size of a digital archive and the funding behind it can be much more difficult to grasp on a website than if you were standing in its library. Being able to ask questions rooted about the underlying economy will enable historians to more easily unearth the structural bias that can exist between different areas of study or different materials.

Jensen presents the argument that historians learning how to navigate digital archives as well as understanding their technical design is imperative to actually engaging with the underlying material.² Jensen identifies three general aspects of digital archives' systems design that historians need to be aware of. (1) predefined subject categories and tags, (2) algorithms/search fields and sorting/display of results and (3) metadata³. Understanding the application of these terms means being able to interact with the digital material in a similar way we would analog material, in practical terms this could mean analyzing the metadata of a given dataset before engaging with the data: Looking into the publisher, and the methods of data collection, just like you would familiarize yourself with the author of another historical material.

Part 2

¹ Helle Strandgaard Jensen, "Digital Archival Literacy for (All) Historians", *Media History* 27, no. 2 (2021): 251–65, pp. 5–6.

² Jensen, "Digital Archival Literacy," pp. 6–7

³ Jensen, "Digital Archival Literacy," pp. 6–7

2.1 I have chosen the interview of a man named Boguslaw, the name does not inform Broder of his last name or any other of his personal information. The interview was conducted on September 24, 1946 at the UNRRA University for Displaced Persons at the Deutsches Museum in Munich, Germany.

The metadata of the file contains subject keywords such as World war, Warsaw ghetto and Gross-Rosen the concentration camp in which Boguslaw was kept, these subject keywords makes it possible for the interview of Boguslaw to be examined and searched within different categories like persons who were imprisoned in the same concentration camp. In the commentary on the interview there is provided background information on Boguslaw at the time of the interview as well as general information about the holocaust. There is written a summary of his story from the time of the war. The commentary informs about Boguslaw plans to emigrate to Palestine, something that is not in his interview, as well as commenting about how Boguslaw seems to be misremembering some details of his story. This is notable since his backstory is impossible to know without this commentary and that it can be difficult to derive directly from the interview the mistakes in his retelling.

In the interview he talks about his time in the Polish-resistance movement, about the Warsaw ghetto uprising and his time in Pawiak prison. He talks much about the horror of his time in both prison and later when he was evacuated to Gross-Rosen concentration camp.

2.2 Listening to the interview allows us access to a part of the narrative that written text simply does not cover. Broder sets the stage in a formal and calm manner, as he then turns to question Boguslaw in German, with the digitized version of the interview we get to listen to Boguslaw as he starts his story in German, slow and often correcting himself he doesn't convey much as he talks. He then asks to switch to Polish for the remainder of the interview and as he continues in this new language he already seems more comfortable as he more easily explains the story of his time during the war. The confidence and familiarity that Boguslaw displays in Polish is both touching but also historically relevant. and listening to the switch allows us to pick up on this.

As the subject turns to the horrors Boguslaw experienced in prison the auditory experiencing of the interview is also important as the emotion in his voice acts as a tool bringing the listener closer to the event described. Without his voice we may not understand the gravity of his story quite as well.

Another insight you can gather from the recording of the interview is Boder's voice. His calm tone guiding both Boguslaw and now us as we listen helps the understanding of the chronological order of the story that Boguslaw tells. Border's role in the interview is not just asking the questions of Boguslaw but is creating a space and a possibility for the interviewee to express parts of their story they find important.

Part 3

Both Digitised historical materials and reborn digital sources have both had a role in changing the world of historians. but they require two different critical approaches if they are to be employed correctly.

Digitized historical sources are material that were originally analog and have since been converted into digital backups, this includes scans of manuscripts, newspapers or archival records. The availability of these materials have transformed the way historical research can be conducted, Sean M. Kelley's discussion of the Transatlantic Slave Trade Database or "Voyages"⁴ is a prime example of how digitization enables large-scale quantitative analysis and new research questions, with the transformation of analog ship manifest into easily searchable databases allows for analysing the material on a much larger scale. Voyages allowed historians to map regional connections between Africa and the Americas in ways that transformed debates about African American culture and the formation of diasporic identities. Tho it must just as well be noted that the large scale processing of data can risk losing the lived experience that is available in the materials, When the bodies of enslaved people are reduced to searchable integers, the achieve risks losing just as much as it stands to gain from the quantity of material that can be analyzed. The risk of trading Quality for

⁴ Sean M. Kelley, "DB or Not DB: Writing the History of the Slave Trade to North America in the Era of the Database", *History Compass* 17, nr. 5 (2019): side1,2 og 5, <https://doi.org/10.1111/hic3.12530>.);

quantity is important to keep in mind when working with these types of data. anyone who interacts with the data should keep this in mind.

Reborn digital sources, such as websites, originate as born-digital materials, but through web archiving they are transformed. An example of such a source could be found on the Wayback Machine, Brügger discusses the Wayback Machine software developed by the Internet Archive. the achieve works by taking web fragments and reassembling them so that a webpage can be reconstructed as it looked like in the past⁵ According to Brügger, the archived web is not a stable copy of an original but a unique, incomplete, and inconsistent reconstruction shaped by strategies, technical constraints, and archival decisions. The great benefit of the archived web is the different analytical approaches we can take with thsi material. We can not just study the content of an old website but the structure as well as changes in these over time. Because the web is everchanging the fragment meant to create a whole picture can often be taken from different times óf the same page thereby creating both temporal and spatial mistakes in the material.

Both digitized and reborn digital sources have strengths that allow for completely new and revolutionary approaches to historical analysis, but both materials also carry significant problems that modern historians now face as the first. The different materials should be treated differently in historical research because they are so different in their strengths and weaknesses. Ultimately the distinction between them is not about choosing which is better but about being aware and recognizing the differences. Treating them the same will just leave you blind to their greatness and somehow also everything that can go wrong. whereas treating them according to an understanding of their differences allows historians to use what will undoubtedly become one of our greatest resources.

⁵ Niels Brügger, 'Understanding the Archived Web as a Historical Source,' in *The SAGE Handbook of Web History* (London: SAGE, 2019).

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